

**Faithful
Foundations**

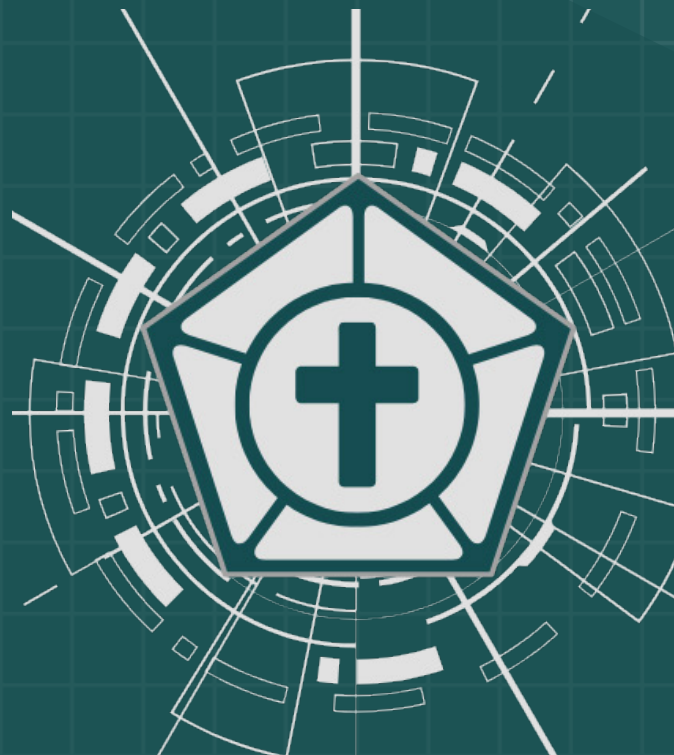
**Future-Ready
Formation**

Catholic Companion Framework

For Technology and Innovation

**Faithful Guidance
for Catholic Educators
Navigating Technology,
Artificial Intelligence,
& Innovation**

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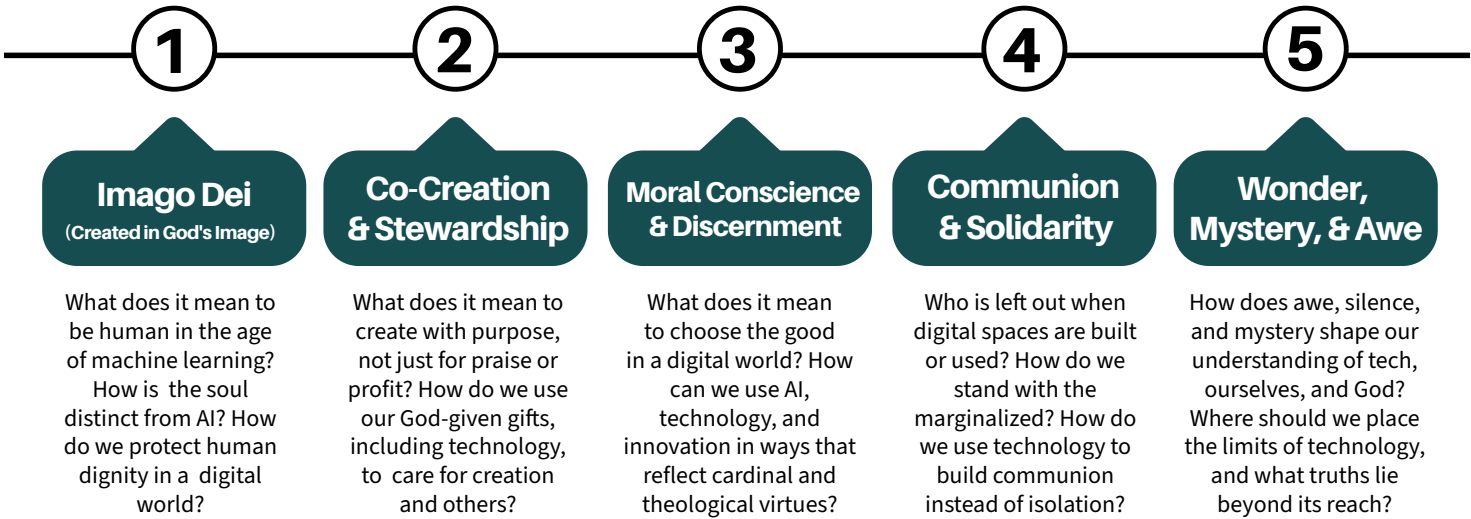
First Edition.

The Loyola Marymount University iDEAL Institute is an authorized partner in the professional development and implementation of this framework.

Framework's Anchor Strands

At the heart of the Catholic Companion Framework are five key strands. Each strand names a central truth of Catholic teaching and applies it to the evolving landscape of technology, AI, and innovation. Together, they form a coherent vision of digital discipleship, one that integrates technical skills with moral conscience, creativity with responsibility, and knowledge with wisdom.

The strands are not designed to stand alone. **They weave together, much like the threads of a fabric, to give Catholic schools, families, and parishes a sturdy foundation for navigating digital life.** *Imago Dei* grounds the framework in human dignity. *Co-Creation & Stewardship* reminds us of our responsibility to use innovation for the common good. *Moral Conscience & Discernment* shapes the daily choices students make online. *Communion & Solidarity* calls them to use technology to build community and justice. *Wonder, Mystery & Awe* keeps alive the sense that not all truth can be measured, coded, or automated. Woven together, the strands remind us that progress and innovation is not only about what technology can make possible, but what love, wisdom, and justice say it should.



Each strand then expands into five smaller substrands that guide development across grade levels, uniting principles of Catholic moral theology with the competencies outlined in modern AI literacy frameworks. This developmental progression reflects the truth that formation is not a one-time event but a lifelong journey. What begins as a young child learning to treat others kindly in digital spaces matures into a college student discerning how their vocation can place technology at the service of humanity.

For educators, the strands serve as guiding principles, shaping lesson design, classroom reflection, and schoolwide vision. For families and parishes, they provide a shared language for guiding children's digital lives at home and in community. For students, they create a pathway of growth that equips them not only with digital competence but with the virtues and habits of discipleship.

Together, these strands form a vision of digital discipleship that is both deeply Catholic and urgently relevant. They offer a framework that accompanies learners through every stage of growth, ensuring that formation evolves alongside both the student and the changing landscape of technology.

Imago Dei (Created in God's Image)

In a world where machines can simulate creativity, conversation, and even emotion, students are invited to ask what makes humanity sacred. *Imago Dei* anchors that question in the truth that each person bears the image of God and is capable of reason, love, and relationship in ways no technology, however advanced, can imitate. This strand guides students to see dignity as a gift, not achievement, and to measure value not by efficiency but by the divine spark within every human life.



Co-Creation & Stewardship

Students are surrounded by tools that promise endless creation, from apps and code to machines that can build almost anything at the click of a button. *Co-Creation & Stewardship* teaches them that to create is also to care. This strand grounds innovation in reverence for the Creator and for creation itself, reminding students that their digital designs touch both human lives and the earth that sustains them. To co-create with God is to shape technology that serves the common good and protects the world entrusted to our care.



Moral Conscience & Discernment

Students navigate a digital world filled with constant decisions about what to share, create, and consume. Algorithms shape attention and influence choices, often blurring the line between what is easy and what is right. *Moral Conscience & Discernment* forms students to pause and weigh their actions in light of truth, justice, and love. Grounded in virtue and guided by faith, they learn that conscience is not a feeling or a rule but a relationship with God that calls them to act with integrity in every digital space.



Communion & Solidarity

Digital spaces shape how young people relate to one another. Social media can foster connection, but it can also create envy, exclusion, and division. Online platforms can amplify marginalized voices, or they can silence and erase them. AI systems have the power to broaden access or to deepen inequities through bias. *Community and Solidarity* helps students see that their digital lives are not just personal but communal, and that every click, post, or design decision can strengthen or weaken the body of Christ.



Wonder, Mystery, and Awe

In a world of constant noise and instant answers, students rarely experience the quiet that gives rise to wonder. The *Wonder, Mystery & Awe* strand invites them to slow down, to notice beauty, and to recognize that truth cannot always be measured or explained. This strand nurtures humility before God and reverence for the unknown, helping students see that wisdom is found not in control but in contemplation. Through awe and attentiveness, they learn to approach both faith and technology with gratitude and grace.

